



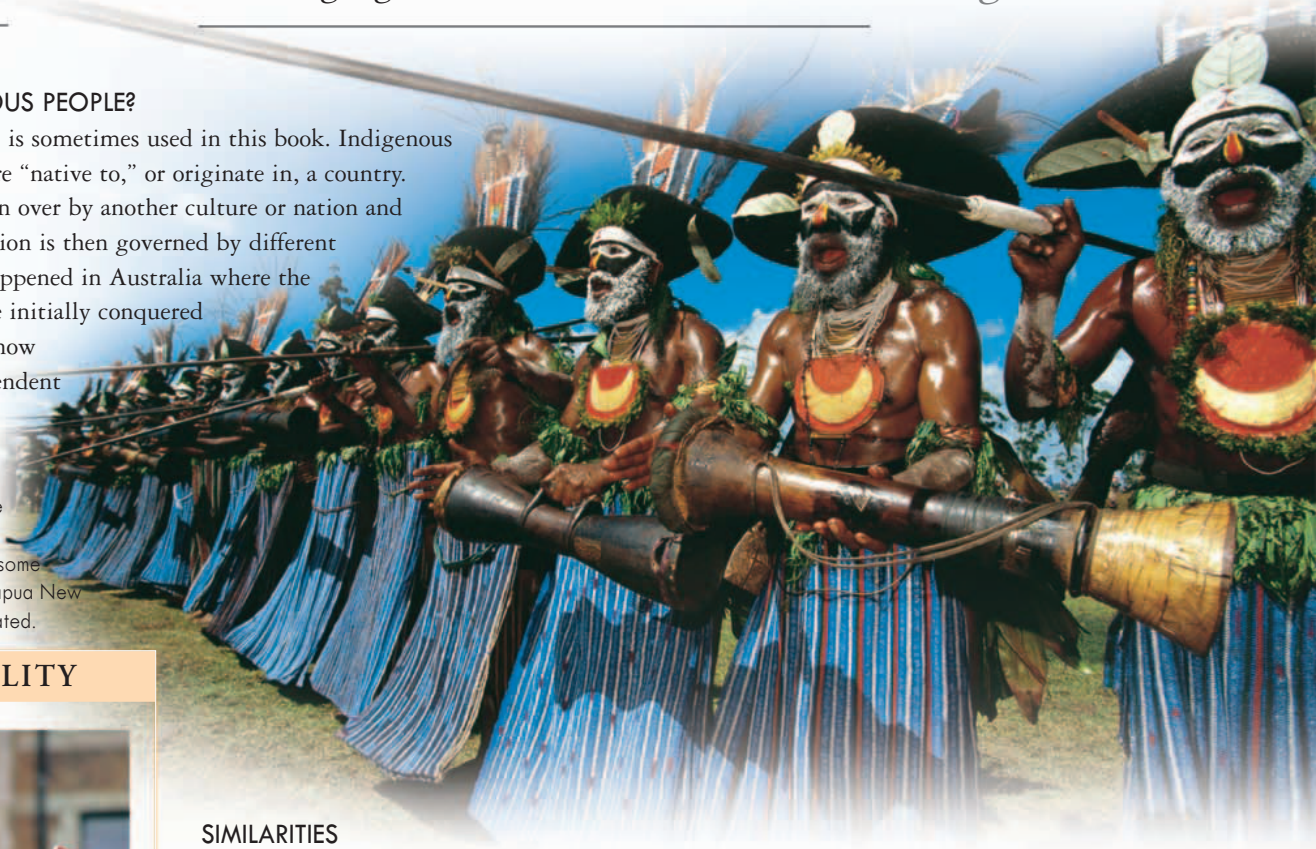
forests of Papua New Guinea there are societies who live **traditional** lifestyles, while in nearby Australia the cities buzz with the latest technology and fashions. Some people believe that **cultures** and languages

are disappearing due to the influence of the modern world—globalization. However, it is clear from this book that people still **value** the cultural variations that make our world all the more **interesting**.

WHO ARE INDIGENOUS PEOPLE?

The word “indigenous” is sometimes used in this book. Indigenous people are those who are “native to,” or originate in, a country. Often a country is taken over by another culture or nation and the indigenous population is then governed by different people. This is what happened in Australia where the indigenous people were initially conquered by the British and are now governed by the independent Australian nation.

There are very few indigenous people with little contact with the rest of the world. There are, however, some rain forest communities in Papua New Guinea that are totally isolated.



NATIONALITY



The world is divided into countries that have their own nationality. There can be many ethnic groups within a country, as in Canada, or in some cases, as in Japan, they are almost entirely made up of one.

SIMILARITIES

In many countries today people from different ethnic groups live and work together, thus creating the vibrant mix that makes up the modern world. Although people may seem different, we all have a lot of things in common—all people have the need to work, value family and relations, and like to feel a sense of community. People may have their differences, but we are at our core essentially the same—we are all human.



In many countries children are educated together regardless of their ethnic or cultural differences.